

Fair Opportunity Exception (FOE) Limited Source Justification and Approval (J&A)

(For use when limiting sources IAW 16.505(b)(2))

Authority: (FAR 16.505)

Project/Program Name: USSOCOM GLOBAL FIELD SERVICE ENGINEERS (GFSE)

Component/PEO/Other: PEO-SOF Digital Applications

Estimated Contract Cost (including options): \$6,374,841.59

J&A Basic Value: \$6,374,841.59

J&A No.

25 - 3690

1. Agency and Contracting Activity: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(1)

(U) HQ USSOCOM/SOF AT&L-SOF DIGITAL APPLICATIONS

7701 TAMPA POINT BLVD

MACDILL AFB, FL 33621

(U) HQ USSOCOM/SOF AT&L-KD

7701 TAMPA POINT BLVD

MACDILL AFB, FL 33621

2. Description of Action: (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(3) Bridge Action (Yes ☒ or No ☐)

(U) This Justification and Approval (J&A) approves the issuance of a bridge task order based on other than full and open competition to Belcan Government Solutions, Inc., Cage Code 1HLV0. The task order type will be Firm Fixed Price with Travel cost only CLIN. Special Operations Forces Mission Command (SOFMC) requires continued support for Mission Command and Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR) activities for USSOCOM [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] while a new contract is being competed. The need for continued support requires the issuance of a three (3) month bridge task order with an additional three (3) – one (1) month option periods to meet mission requirements while on-going competition for the follow-on acquisition is being completed. The new requirement is not going to be awarded on time to prevent a break in service but is planned to be awarded before September 2025.

(U) The current task order was awarded in 2020 which included a base year with 3 option years and a 6-month extension. The task order was awarded by USSOCOM SOF AT&L. The task order's 6-month 52.217-8 extension was exercised by SOF AT&L on 26 Aug 2024. The current period of performance through 27 March 2025 is the final option period for the task order. The new task order will bridge the gap between the current task order and the new, competed contract. The bridge will allow continuity of critical Mission Command and Intelligence services consequently avoiding real-world mission failure of Global SOF forces. The total estimated value for this task order is \$6,374,841.59 in Operations and Maintenance funding. This cost was derived from rates determined through [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] the current GFSE Task Order, H9240420F0286, were taken into consideration when developing the estimated value.

3. Description of Supplies/Services: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(2)

(U) This bridge task order is to provide software agnostic field support for forward-deployed users of operational and advanced analytic intelligence support systems activities. Field services include engineering and technical administration as well as embedded data services and analytical support and mentorship for workflow development, data source integration, and expert utilization of multiple software capabilities to solve mission critical information challenges. The scope encompasses the SOF Enterprise defined as Headquarters United States Special Operations Command (USSOCOM) [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] Global Field Service Engineers (GFSE) shall support SOF users of operational and intelligence platforms [REDACTED]

4. Authority Cited Permitting Sources of Fair Opportunity Exception and Rationale: (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(4))

☒ FAR 16.505(b)(2)(i)(C), "The order must be issued on a sole-source basis in the interest of economy and efficiency because it is a logical follow-on to an order already issued under the contract, provided that all awardees were given a fair opportunity to be considered for the original order".

(U) USSOCOM has a continuing need for Mission Command and Intelligence, Surveillance, and Reconnaissance (ISR) support services. The current task order was issued under the GSA Government-Wide Acquisition Contract (GWAC) and was competed amongst small business contract holders. Belcan Government Solutions was determined to be the best value to the government and awarded the task order. The Task Order period of performance ends on 27 March 2025.

(U) Belcan Government Solutions is the current contractor knowledgeable in global field support engineering services required for Mission Command and ISR execution [REDACTED] Belcan has been in place since September 2020, providing professional and technical support services for Special Operations Mission Command and ISR activities across the SOF enterprise. Belcan is experienced in the specialized the technical and analytical mission planning and execution systems support. Belcan has been exposed to the critical intricacies of Mission Command and ISR processes and procedures.

(U) The bridge task order requires [REDACTED] Full Time Equivalents (FTE) at a CONUS and OCONUS locations. These individuals have been performing these services and have acquired subject matter expertise and situational awareness of Mission Command and ISR services and the SOF mission.

(U) The bridge task order is a logical follow-on to the expiring task order. The scope of this bridge task order is identical to the current GFSE contract. No changes, outside of the description of the requiring organization were made. All offerors were given fair opportunity to compete on the original task order. In the interest of efficiency, it is best to have Belcan continue to provide the services while the next, competitive, contract is being finished. By continuing to have Belcan perform this requirement the government is going to realize stabilized performance vice having a new contractor attempt to phase in, transition personnel, learn the contract, and then finally start to perform to the level that is required. The short period of this bridge task order will not allow another contractor to become fully proficient on delivering the required services. The government would lose the efficiencies gained during the last 4 years of the current task order with no benefit going forward. Not only would this cause a degradation of service, but the short nature of this bridge task order increases a new contractor's risk to personnel employment and there would be a price premium paid above and beyond the price of having Belcan continue to provide the required services in the short term.

5. Efforts/Actions to Increase Competition: (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(7))

(U) The forthcoming, competed contract action is for the Global Systems Support Engineers (GSSE) requirement, a new requirement that will encompass and supersede the current GFSE requirement. The primary focus of GSSE is to cross-train personnel that can operate in multiple domains, one of which being the domain of the current GFSE contract. A bridge contract is required to have time to award GSSE while ensuring that GFSE services are still operational, so as not to experience substantial mission degradation.

(U) Market research to survey industry's ability to meet the new requirement began in March 2023 and has been concluded. This bridge task order is a one-time requirement; the subsequent action is currently being competed and is expected to be awarded in FY25. The GSSE contract was originally to be awarded by the end of the current GFSE task order; however, growth and changing requirements added an additional layer of complexity to the GSSE requirement. Additionally, ambiguity in the GSSE's RFP drove a proposal extension for all vendors and the SSEB team was delayed in the completion of their technical evaluation and analysis due to two mandatory hurricane evacuations in September/October that resulted in widespread damage to MacDill AFB and the surrounding cities to include flooding, loss of power, and other water damage that caused personnel disruption for several months. This led to the loss of 14 business days and additional time to make living conditions suitable for living upon return from mandatory evacuations. Also, the departure of the primary executing personnel on the recompetit effort and the need to find a replacement contracting officer contributed to the delays.

(U) As stated above, to overcome barriers to entry, the government is competing the requirement going forward with the intent of setting the requirement aside for small businesses. This will allow companies to partner with one another and use one another's experience to be successful in working on this requirement in the future. The new requirement is not going to be awarded on time to prevent a break in service but is planned to be awarded before September 2025.

6. Market Research: (FAR 8.405-6(c)(2)(vi))

(U) A Request for Information (RFI) for similar capabilities to the updated requirement, GSSE, was posted in October 2023, which yielded several results. PM SOF Mission Command and Intel performed a comprehensive review of those submissions as a basis for this bridge task order. There were [REDACTED] submissions [REDACTED] for this RFI; however, to fulfill this particular requirement it was determined that no company, other than Belcan, would be able to satisfy the requirement. Belcan is the only company that can satisfy the requirement before the end of the current order. Additionally, the Engage SOF (eSOF) database was also reviewed as a part of this market research. No vendors were found within the eSOF



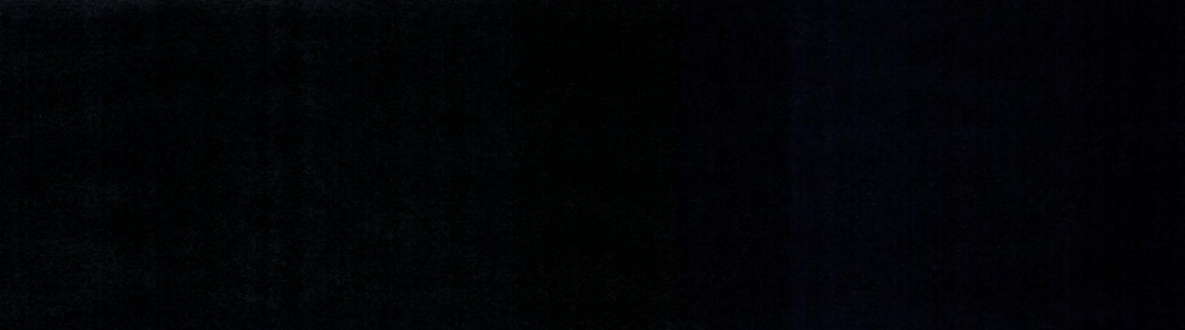
database who would be able to provide the required services in the short turnaround window without a disruption/degradation to critical mission services.

(U) In order to ascertain whether or not vendors would now be capable of performing the requirement without the loss of efficiencies as well as substantial learning and re-work, internet searches have continuously been conducted. This is in addition to contact with industry partners that perform, or may be able to perform, in this field.

(U) The most recent market research occurred in November 2024 in which a review of numerous potential vendors yielded the conclusion that award of this contract to a vendor other than the incumbent would undeniably result in a loss to efficiencies gained over the last 4 years of the task order and would require substantial learning and re-work by a new vendor in order to properly perform the requirement. With the short nature of this bridge task order and considering the above analysis, it makes logical sense to award the bridge task order to Belcan for the three (3) month period with three (3) – one (1) month option periods, in the interest of economy and efficiency.

7. Interested Sources:

(U) As stated above, [REDACTED] capability statements were received in response to RFI H9241524RFI01 for similar capabilities, posted October 2023 on sam.gov. Of those submissions only Belcan has the capability to fulfill the requirement and provide the level of service that the government needs in the short term until a competitive contract is awarded. Submissions were received from [REDACTED]



8. Other Facts Supporting the Justification: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(6))

N/A





9. Technical and Requirements Certification: FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(9))

I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief:

NAME:



TITLE:



SIGNATURE/DATE:





10. Fair and Reasonable Cost Determination: (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(7))

Upon receipt of Belcan Government Solutions, Inc proposal, I hereby determine that the anticipated cost or price to the Government for this contract action will be fair and reasonable. The pricing of the current services is currently available for comparison and it is expected that prices will remain similar with a probable escalation rate due to inflation.

CONTRACTING OFFICER SIGNATURE IN SECTION 12 BELOW ALSO SERVES AS THE PRICE FAIR AND REASONABLENESS DETERMINATION IN THIS SECTION.

11. Contracting Officer Certification: (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(8))

I hereby certify that this J&A is complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

NAME: Michael F. White

TITLE: SOF AT&L-KD Contracting Officer

SIGNATURE/DATE:





12. Legal: SOFARS 5601-1

Legal review complete (see legal review):

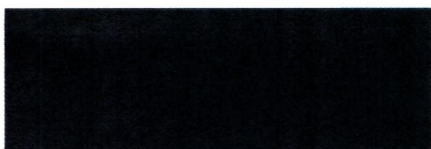
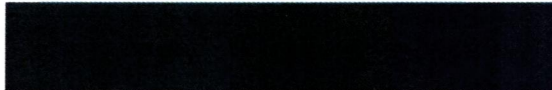
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TITLE:



SIGNATURE/DATE:



13. Head of Contracting Division (HCD): (FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(B)(10), SOFARS 5601-1)

I have reviewed this document and find the J&A adequate to support other than full and open competition:

NAME: [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] DATE: _____

14. Approval:**(FAR 16.505(b)(2)(ii)(C)(2), SOFARS 5601-1)**

Based upon the foregoing justification, I hereby approve the procurement of Global Field Support Engineers in the estimated amount of \$6,374,841.59. The requirement will be released under solicitation TBD on an other than full and open competition basis. The action(s) pursuant to this J&A are subject to the availability of funds and the completion of all required statutory and regulatory reviews and approvals.

NAME: [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] DATE: _____